

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner who ships AI features, not just roadmaps.*

Positioning, B2B SaaS operator with ten years translating messy stakeholder requirements into working software – including AI integrations in Microsoft-adjacent enterprise environments.

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§ WHY BOARDWISE

Boardwise sits at an interesting intersection: enterprise governance software that is mission-critical but historically underserved by good product thinking. The explicit callout of AI integration in the Microsoft ecosystem – Copilot, LLM-based features, M365 and Azure – matches exactly the kind of product work I have been doing, not as a strategic aspiration but as shipped increments. The fact that more than 30 % of DAX companies already trust the platform signals that the core value proposition is proven; the product challenge now is deepening that value through intelligent automation without introducing complexity that board offices cannot absorb. *That is precisely the problem space where I do my best work.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

My background is in industrial software, public data platforms, and InsurTech – not in governance or legal-entity management software specifically. The transferable mechanic is strong: at Emil Group I delivered a Claims Center for primary insurers and reinsurers under exactly the same structural constraint – regulated users, zero tolerance for ambiguity, complex approval workflows that must be both auditable and fast.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication drafts and structured analysis
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo feature support and code review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, spec-to-implementation cycles
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for concept validation
- **Framer**, design-heavy stakeholder mockups
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, structured product documentation and presentations

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Django, JavaScript, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, REST APIs, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, Git, Bitbucket – across production deployments in defence, public sector, InsurTech, and healthcare.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTEST & AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

A self-built crypto market backtest engine and autonomous dev-agent framework.

- Implements a file-queue-based agent loop for autonomous task execution across multiple LLM backends.
- Architecture uses structured prompt pipelines and modular tool registries, making it straightforward to extend with new data sources or decision modules.
- Covers live market microstructure data ingestion from venues including Hyperliquid and Bitget, feeding into algorithmic decision frameworks.
- Demonstrates the same agentic-workflow design thinking I apply when scoping LLM-based product features – relevant for Boardwise's Copilot and LLM integration roadmap.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT BOARDWISE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow existing sprint ceremonies and stakeholder touchpoints, map the current backlog structure against stated product vision, and identify where prioritisation logic or acceptance criteria are weakest – particularly around the AI feature pipeline.

WEEK 2

Sharpen, slice, validate.

Restructure the highest-priority backlog items into properly scoped user stories with explicit acceptance criteria, and run a focused refinement session with engineering to surface hidden complexity early.

WEEK 3+

Ship, close, repeat.

Own the first increment through to release, establish a lightweight but consistent cadence for backlog health, and begin mapping the next AI integration opportunity against real user workflows in board offices.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Boardwise team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role for digital products and AI. I have spent the better part of ten years doing exactly what this role describes: standing between stakeholders who have real but inarticulate needs and engineering teams who need precise, prioritised work. The context has changed – defence AI platforms, public labour market analytics, InsurTech SaaS – but the mechanic is constant.

The part of this posting that caught my attention was not the AI integration work in isolation, but the combination of that with Vorstandsebene stakeholder management. At Emil Group I had to rebuild trust with C-level contacts at primary insurers and reinsurers after the product had missed commitments. I introduced structured weekly workshops, made every sprint increment demonstrably tangible, and reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure over the engagement. Boardwise's users – board secretariats, executive

assistants, and Vorstandsmitglieder themselves – operate under similar pressure: low tolerance for ambiguity, high sensitivity to quality and reliability, and a genuine need for the product to reduce friction rather than create new kinds of it.

On the AI side: at Rohde & Schwarz, working within the FCAS programme, I delivered AI data management features end-to-end – user stories through implementation support through GitOps rollout – in a Microsoft-adjacent infrastructure environment with Kubernetes, ArgoCD, and OpenShift. I also reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps practices the team had been unable to implement before. Translating LLM-based features into backlog items that engineering can actually execute, with acceptance criteria that account for model behaviour edge cases, is something I do routinely with my own tooling and have done in production contexts.

At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I served additionally as Deputy IT Security Officer, which means I understand the compliance and data lineage concerns that enterprise customers in regulated sectors bring to conversations about AI features. That is not a checkbox – it directly shapes how I write acceptance criteria for anything that touches user data or decision audit trails.

Boardwise is working on a genuinely interesting problem. Strategic decision-making processes in large organisations are almost entirely analogue in practice, regardless of what software sits underneath them. The opportunity to make those processes faster, more traceable, and more defensible through well-designed software and carefully introduced AI is real, and the DAX customer base means the feedback loops are high-quality and high-stakes. I would like to be part of that.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with nearly ten years of experience in B2B SaaS, enterprise software, and AI-integrated platforms. Comfortable owning the full product increment lifecycle – discovery, backlog management, stakeholder alignment, implementation support, and rollout – in agile environments where requirements shift and delivery pressure is high. Proven track record of rebuilding sprint discipline, regaining client trust, and shipping AI-adjacent features in Microsoft-ecosystem and Kubernetes-based environments. Native German speaker with C2 English; experienced at communicating with Vorstandsebene and technical stakeholders in both languages.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Backlog ownership, prioritisation, and structured refinement
- Translating board-level requirements into dev-ready user stories
- Stakeholder management at management and Vorstand level in German and English
- AI feature integration within enterprise software products
- Microsoft ecosystem product familiarity: M365, Azure-adjacent deployments
- Sprint discipline restoration and cross-functional team alignment
- Compliance-aware product thinking: data lineage, audit trails, IT security
- End-to-end feature delivery: stories through GitOps rollout
- Rapid prototyping and LLM-assisted requirement engineering

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered AI and data management features end-to-end, including user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
- Integrated AI/ML concepts including SafeAI and ExplainableAI into acceptance criteria and product documentation for multinational defence stakeholders
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered in one week a feature that had been pending from engineers for over a year
- Led cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA
- Maintained full data provenance, audit trails, and reproducible transformation pipelines across multimodal datasets

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Owned backlog and roadmap for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform, delivering labour shortage analytics, regional comparison tools, and modernised admin tooling
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and standardised CI/CD with full test integration

- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Designed interactive dashboards, community features, and modernised stakeholder-facing interfaces

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Rebuilt sprint discipline for a 17-person team: split into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking, structured refinement, and ownership concepts
- Delivered Claims Center module from concept to production rollout for primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, brokers, and underwriters
- Regained client trust at management level through structured weekly product workshops after a period of missed commitments
- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure over the engagement

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Owned product for a mobile-first hospital app across iOS and Android under tight deadlines
- Delivered core flows: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, managing complex legacy API constraints
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner & Deputy IT Security Officer

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- Designed backup, restore, checkpoint, and encryption flows for a product targeting non-technical end users; setup under two minutes with no technical knowledge required
- Served as deputy IT security officer, covering attack vector mitigation and compliance

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Co-founded a group-based P2P payment platform; designed full UX/UI, integrated PSP, and built a mobile app prototype
- Platform later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Migrated internal webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration and customisable approval policies

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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